

Week 20: Apostles

BIG IDEA

It's easy to be a Christian at camp or youth group; not so easy everywhere else. The apostles were eyewitnesses who lived with Jesus, saw him die and rise, and were willing to die for that message. Nobody dies for what they know is a lie, so their fate is testimony students must reckon with.

KEY POINTS FROM THE LEADER VIDEO

- Mountaintop retreat experiences fade by Monday because Christianity is cool inside the youth-group pressure cooker but not out in the world where following Jesus is hard.
- We know little about the apostles' lives, but many gave and all were willing to give their lives for the message they preached.
- In Acts 4:20 Peter and John, facing persecution and threats, insist they cannot stop speaking about what they have seen and heard.
- Students will object that others die for beliefs too; the difference is the apostles were eyewitnesses who lived with Jesus and saw him die and resurrect.
- You will not die for something you know is a lie; this proves nothing beyond all doubt, but it shows the apostles were not lying.
- Exact fates of some apostles are debated church tradition, but they suffered and died; the unit closes with miracles, resurrection, and deity converging in their testimony.

SCRIPTURE

Acts 4:20

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. How would you describe the conviction the apostles had for their message, and do you agree with it?
2. If you absolutely saw something and knew it was true, how far would you go to make sure the truth came out?
3. What fate did the apostles meet for spreading the gospel, and what does that mean for your faith?
4. Knowing all this about miracles, the resurrection, and the apostles, how will you live differently moving forward?

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